ARAVIND NATARAJAN

Program & Delivery Manager | *Agile Product Ownership* | *Quality & Operations Excellence* | *AI-Driven Process Improvement*
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Program and delivery leader with nearly a decade across **Amazon**, **Brightcove** and a **0-to-1 mandate** at a US grocery-retail delivery platform (Series A, $11M+ raised). Builds the operating model that makes fast-moving, multi-team delivery **predictable**: stage gates and go/no-go, RAID, RAG and KPI reporting, risk and dependency management, root-cause analysis with corrective actions, and **AI-first process improvement**. At Buncha, ran delivery governance for a 35-person tech org across **150+ releases**, led engineering delivery for the **Meijer rollout**, owned product features end to end and cut defect leakage from **75%+ to under 20%**. Strong stakeholder manager across executives, clients and onshore-offshore teams (US, UK, APAC).

IMPACT AT A GLANCE

150+ releases governed | **75%+ to under 20%** defect leakage | **~80% fewer** escalations | **3 to 13** store Meijer rollout
$69K+ annual savings | **1,300+** engineering hours reclaimed with AI tools | **50+** client projects | Teams of **10+** led

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

BUNCHA | Remote | May 2025 – Sep 2026

Quality Assurance Manager (Delivery Governance, Release Management & Product Ownership)

US grocery-retail delivery platform partnering with retailers such as Meijer (Series A, $11M+ raised)

- **Built the 0-to-1 delivery operating model for a 35-person tech org**, moving from daily hotfixes to a predictable weekly and bi-weekly cadence across 150+ releases with three stage gates (QA sign-off, UAT with feature owners, leadership sign-off), go/no-go, RACI and P0–P3 severity; defect leakage fell from 75%+ to under 20% and app crashes 85%.
- **Led engineering delivery for the Meijer rollout** (3 stores at launch, 13 today; 1-hour delivery on schedule, ~370 daily orders, $5,000+ daily revenue): owned the integrated plan, milestones, RAID log and go-live checklists, ran handoffs and issue resolution with Meijer's engineering team, and shipped a self-serve shopping-to-delivery flow saving ~4 hours a week.
- **Managed risks and dependencies across 30+ cross-functional initiatives** (engineering, product, ops, catalog, support), including DoorDash, Uber and Onfleet integrations, dynamic ETAs, dispatcher automation and 1099 payments.
- **Owned KPI tracking and executive reporting**: built the company-wide release and team tracker in Excel and ClickUp (readiness, RAG status, escape rate, DRE, bug SLA, capacity), sent weekly written updates to the Head of Product and the CEO, and sat on the executive release-priority (steering) panel; demo-data version in portfolio.
- **Found and fixed delivery bottlenecks with data**: analysed where tasks stalled and who they waited on, bug-fix turnaround by developer and escape trends; moved sign-off from the end of the cycle into planning (PRDs and acceptance criteria agreed a week before sprint), set a 60/40 planned-to-reactive capacity split and used escape data to tighten test coverage.
- **Took on Product Owner duties for the final five months**: wrote PRDs and user stories with acceptance criteria for ~10 features, owned several end to end and prioritized the backlog weekly with the PM; created the PRD sign-off gate before engineering, which caught conflicting capacity-check and ETA-routing logic and forced a full rewrite.
- **Ran error management end to end**: daily root-cause analysis with corrective and preventive actions and same-day fixes for customer issues; authored the incident-severity framework and escalation matrix adopted by Support, SRE and Engineering and built the business case for an after-hours SRE hire, cutting SOS escalations ~80% (4–6 a week to 3–4 a month).
- **Standardized ways of working through SOPs** (release and go-live checklists, PRD sign-off, bug-report and test-case standards, onboarding and tool ramp-up guides) used by QA and adopted by engineering teams; set validation controls with the catalog team for item data (names, prices, images, substitutions), backed by SQL and Metabase checks.
- **Led a 4-person QA team, including a QA Lead,** in a 35-person tech org (12–16 developers): hiring, KPIs, reviews, growth plans and coaching the QA Lead; ran daily standups, sprint estimation and retrospectives, facilitated company-wide sprint ceremonies on rotation, and held cadence through an unbacked headcount reduction.
- **Drove AI adoption and enablement**: led the Claude rollout across QA, catalog and product teams, ran Support training sessions, monthly go-live briefings and company-wide bug bashes, and onboarded every new ops and engineering hire.

  AI and automation tools built (1,300+ engineering hours and $14,800 reclaimed a year):

  - **Bytecast** (live on the Chrome Web Store): Claude-powered extension that files complete bug reports (video, logs, network, steps) into Jira, ClickUp and 8 other trackers in one click.
  - **FlowForge** (built with AI): Android app that records user flows and generates pytest + Appium 2 test scripts, with GitHub PR export and AI review of weak locators and missing assertions.
  - **Test-order admin tool:** creates test orders from live production and Elasticsearch data in under 1 min (from ~18), removing a ~$30 per-order cost; adopted company-wide for in-store trials and Greenhouse onboarding.

- **Unified alerting platform:** co-built with SRE one view of New Relic, Datadog, Redis and RabbitMQ alerts across environments, exposing two runaway services and removing ~100K redundant daily service calls.

BRIGHTCOVE | Chennai, India | Dec 2021 – Mar 2025

Quality Assurance Engineer (APAC QA Lead)

Global video and OTT streaming platform (enterprise professional services)

- **Owned APAC delivery quality as a founding member of Brightcove's India professional services team** and the region's only QA engineer, **leading and mentoring 4 contractors** beyond formal scope across 10 enterprise accounts (Spotify, AT&T, BBC, Cisco, Dell, ExxonMobil, GM) in APAC, the US and the UK: 50+ projects, including 5 large enterprise launches.
- **Ran client release reviews and status calls** with enterprise accounts, held back unready releases and built contractor effort estimates with US leads; rollbacks fell by over half and CSAT rose 20%; recognized by the Director, an SVP and clients.
- **Saved $40,000+ a year** in rework and support costs with pre-production gates and a root-cause and triage process built from scratch, cutting recurring issues by over half and invalid defects 40%.
- Validated data integrity on customer content migrations (video metadata) across web, mobile, Android TV and admin consoles; cut regression from 10h to 4h per cycle.

AMAZON | Chennai, India | Dec 2019 – Dec 2021

Sr. Associate, Quality Service

- **Led a team of 10+** across 6 concurrent projects and 28+ features, working daily with US leadership, developers and TPMs across time zones; cut new-hire onboarding from 9 weeks to under 4, lifting team efficiency 30%.
- **Zero launch-blocking auth defects across 18 locales and 20+ device types** as a founding member of Alexa Identity launch operations; owned Alexa Presence testing with the Seattle development team.
- **Planned and controlled the team's QA device and tooling budget**; saved $15,000+ a year by cutting the regression suite from 1,100 to 180 cases (full cycle in 1 day).
- **Automated daily reporting and defect filing** (2h to 20 min a day, 400+ hours a year; 800+ hours over two years) and rewrote defect standards, holding invalid defects under 1% and cutting resolution time 20%.

AMAZON | Chennai, India | Jun 2017 – Dec 2019

Associate, Quality Service

- Streamlined weekly Alexa mobile regression (Android, iOS, Fire Tablets) and grew into end-to-end Alexa Identity validation.
- Earned **9 company awards in 2.5 years** (including Star of the Month and Quarterback Champion) and a fast-track promotion to Sr. Associate.

CORE SKILLS & TOOLS

- **Program & Delivery Management:** Program management, Project management, Delivery management, Delivery strategy & operating model, PMO governance, Integrated plans & milestones, Stage gates & go/no-go, RAID (risk, issue & dependency management), RAG reporting, RACI, Charters & scope, Lessons learned, Release plans & roadmaps, Change management & transformation, Global delivery model, SDLC
- **Stakeholders, People & Financials:** Stakeholder management, Executive reporting, Client & vendor management, Cross-functional leadership, Hiring & interviewing (40+ candidates), Coaching & mentoring, Knowledge sharing, Effort estimation, Resource & capacity planning, Budget & cost tracking, Cost optimization, Business cases
- **Product Ownership & Agile:** PRD & architecture reviews, User stories & acceptance criteria, Backlog prioritization & refinement (business value), Sprint planning & sprint goals, Impediment removal, Release coordination, Voice of the Customer, Defect management, Agile/Scrum, Kanban
- **Operations Excellence & Data Quality:** Process & continuous improvement, Root cause analysis, Corrective & preventive actions, SOPs & controls, Exception & escalation management, Incident management & SLAs, Data accuracy checks, Quality escapes
- **KPIs, Reporting & Analytics:** KPI dashboards, Delivery & quality metrics (defect leakage, DRE, bug SLA, MTTR, productivity), Advanced Excel (pivot tables, formulas, dashboards), Power BI, SQL
- **AI & Automation:** AI-first process improvement, Claude rollout & training, Validating AI outputs (LLM evaluation), Prompt engineering, Claude Code, MCP, Workflow automation (Zapier, Jira automation)
- **Tools & Technical:** Jira (JQL, dashboards, automation rules), Confluence, ClickUp, Excel, PowerPoint, Power BI, Metabase, Datadog, New Relic, Postman, Selenium, Jenkins, GitHub Actions; REST APIs, microservices, CI/CD

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.E., Electronics and Communication Engineering | Sri Krishna College of Engineering and Technology | CGPA 8.13

- IBM Project Management Fundamentals (IBM SkillsBuild, designed with IPMA), 2026
- Six Sigma Yellow Belt Certified | Anthropic Academy: Claude API, MCP, Claude Code and Agent Skills (2026)
- ISTQB Foundation Level (CTFL): in progress, exam planned Jan 2027